

CORTORA

Customer Refund Eligibility and Amount Determination

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COR-PL-010	2.0	Payments Operations	Internal	01 September 2026	Annual

This policy defines when a Cortora customer qualifies for a full or partial refund, how refund amounts are calculated, and how employees and OpsPilot should evaluate refund eligibility. It applies to all consumer electronics, home-office equipment, and smart-home accessories sold through the Cortora marketplace to customers in the European Economic Area and the United Kingdom.

This policy governs refund **eligibility and amount**. The physical or operational process of returning a product is governed separately by the Return Policy. The procedural steps an employee follows when investigating a payment or refund case are governed by the Payment Operations SOP.

1. Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that refund decisions are consistent, defensible, and based on authoritative order and payment data rather than on unverified customer statements. It applies to Support Agents, Support Managers, Payments Specialists, Risk Analysts, and to OpsPilot when it recommends a refund action for human review.

This policy does not grant any employee or AI system the authority to execute a refund outside the limits defined in the Employee Authorization Matrix. Eligibility under this policy is a necessary condition for a refund; it is not by itself sufficient authorization to execute one.

2. Refund Eligibility Categories

Cortora recognizes the following categories of refund eligibility. Each category has a distinct evidentiary requirement that must be satisfied before a refund is recommended.

Category	Description	Typical evidence required
Non-delivery	Order marked SHIPPED or DELIVERED but the customer did not receive the item within the expected delivery window.	Carrier tracking record; delivery confirmation status; elapsed time since last tracking update.
Damaged or defective item	Item arrived damaged, was defective on arrival, or failed within the applicable warranty period.	Customer-submitted description and, where required, photos; product return inspection outcome for physical returns.
Incorrect item shipped	The item received does not match the item ordered (wrong SKU, size, colour, or bundle).	Order Item record compared against the customer's description; warehouse fulfillment log where available.
Duplicate or erroneous charge	Customer was charged more than once for a single order, or charged after an order was cancelled.	Payment transaction history for the order showing two or more CAPTURED transactions of the same amount, or a CAPTURED transaction against a CANCELLED order.

Category	Description	Typical evidence required
Cancellation-eligible refund	Order was cancelled while eligible for cancellation under the Cancellation Policy after payment had already been captured.	Order status history showing a CANCELLED transition and a corresponding CAPTURED payment.
Accepted return	Customer returned the item and the return was accepted under the Return Policy.	Return record with status ACCEPTED and inspection outcome, if applicable.
Goodwill exception	No standard category applies, but a Support Manager determines a refund is appropriate to resolve a customer dispute.	Documented manager rationale in the case notes; subject to the goodwill limits in the Employee Authorization Matrix.

3. Full Refund Conditions

A full refund of the order amount, including any applicable delivery charge, is appropriate when any of the following conditions are met and confirmed against the operational systems of record:

- The order was cancelled before it entered the PROCESSING status and payment had already been captured.
- The item was never delivered and the carrier record confirms the shipment was lost, misrouted, or has been stationary beyond the maximum expected transit time defined in the Shipping & Delivery Policy.
- The item received was materially different from the item ordered (wrong product entirely, not a minor variation).
- A duplicate or erroneous payment transaction was captured for the same order.
- The customer returned the item, the return was accepted, and no restocking or condition-based deduction applies under the Return Policy.

4. Partial Refund Conditions

A partial refund may apply when the customer retains some value from the transaction, or when only part of an order is affected. Common scenarios include:

- Only one item within a multi-item order is affected by damage, defect, or non-delivery; the refund is limited to the price of the affected Order Item plus any delivery charge attributable to it.
- A returned item shows signs of use beyond reasonable inspection, is missing original accessories, or is missing packaging in a way that reduces resale value, subject to the condition-based deduction schedule in the Return Policy.
- A delivery delay caused material inconvenience but the item was eventually delivered in acceptable condition; in this case only the delivery charge, not the full order value, is typically refunded.
- A promotional discount or voucher applied to the original order must be proportionally deducted from the refunded amount so the customer is not refunded more than they paid.

5. Non-Refundable Situations

- The customer changed their mind after the return window defined in the Return Policy has closed, and no damage, defect, or fulfillment error is present.
- The item shows damage that a reasonable inspection indicates was caused after delivery and is not attributable to Cortora or its fulfillment partners.
- The payment transaction is still in PENDING or FAILED status; there is no captured amount to refund.

- A refund for the same payment transaction has already been completed and is confirmed in REFUNDED or PARTIALLY_REFUNDED status consistent with the amount requested.
- The request relates to a digital licence key or activation code that has already been redeemed, except where required by applicable consumer protection law.

Employees should not treat a customer's insistence, frustration, or repeated requests as evidence that a non-refundable situation should be treated as refundable. Repeated or escalating requests that fall outside policy should be escalated per the Escalation Procedures rather than resolved through an unauthorized refund.

6. Refund Amount Calculation

The refundable amount is calculated from the authoritative payment and order records, never from a customer's stated amount. The general calculation is:

- Start from the CAPTURED transaction amount associated with the affected order or order item.
- Subtract any amount already refunded against that transaction, if a PARTIALLY_REFUNDED status exists.
- Apply any condition-based deduction defined in the Return Policy for used, incomplete, or damaged returns.
- Add back a delivery charge only where the delivery charge itself is part of the eligible refund.
- Round to the transaction currency's smallest unit and confirm the result does not exceed the original CAPTURED amount.

7. Refund Method

Refunds are issued to the original payment method used for the transaction wherever technically possible. Refunds to an alternative payment method, bank account, or store credit require Support Manager or Payments Specialist approval and must be documented in the case with the reason the original method could not be used.

8. Authorization and Approval

The monetary thresholds and roles authorized to execute refunds without additional approval are defined in the Employee Authorization Matrix and are not restated here to avoid the two documents drifting out of sync. As a general principle, higher-value refunds, refunds outside the standard categories in Section 2, and refunds flagged by fraud or risk controls require escalated approval before execution.

9. Role of OpsPilot

When OpsPilot is asked to evaluate a refund request, it should retrieve the authoritative payment and order records before recommending a category from Section 2, calculate the proposed amount using Section 6, and clearly state which condition was met and what evidence supports it. OpsPilot must not recommend a refund based solely on the customer's description of the payment or delivery status, and must flag the case for human review whenever the retrieved evidence is incomplete, contradictory, or absent.

10. Related Documents

- Return Policy — governs the physical/operational return process and condition-based deductions.
- Cancellation Policy — governs when an order can be cancelled prior to fulfillment.
- Payment Operations SOP — governs the investigation steps for payment and refund cases.

- Employee Authorization Matrix — governs who may approve and execute refunds at each value tier.
 - Fraud & Risk Policy — governs refund requests connected to suspicious account activity.
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